

PHASE 3 (LETSDEFEND)

Incident Report (SOC282 Phishing Alert)

Incident Details

Incident ID: LD-SOC282-001

Date / Time Detected (UTC): May 13, 2024, 09:22 AM

Analyst Name: Diya

Client / Environment: LetsDefend SOC Environment

Severity: High

Status: Resolved

Alert Type: Exchange

Rule Name: SOC282 - Phishing Alert - Deceptive Mail Detected

Executive Summary

A phishing email was delivered to a user within the organization. The email impersonated a legitimate promotional offer and contained a malicious attachment named **free-coffee.zip**. The recipient downloaded and executed the malware payload (**Coffee.exe**), which subsequently established communication with an external Command-and-Control (C2) server.

Investigation confirmed malicious activity through email analysis, endpoint analysis, and network log review. The incident was classified as a **True Positive** due to successful malware execution and outbound C2 communication.

Timeline of Events

Timestamp (UTC)	Event	Source
May 13, 2024, 09:22 AM	Phishing email received	Exchange Alert
May 13, 2024, 09:22 AM	Alert generated by SOC282 detection rule	SIEM
May 13, 2024, 12:59 PM	User downloaded malicious attachment	Endpoint Logs
May 13, 2024, 12:59 PM	Malware process Coffee.exe executed	Endpoint Logs
May 13, 2024, 01:00 PM	Connection established to external C2 server	Network Logs

Timestamp (UTC)	Event	Source
May 13, 2024	Investigation completed	SOC Analyst

Affected Assets

Asset	Value
User	Felix
Destination Email	felix@letsdefend.io
Host IP	172.16.20.151
Process	Coffee.exe
Process ID	6697

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Sender Email	free@coffeeshoop.com
Subject	Free Coffee Voucher
Attachment	free-coffee.zip
SMTP Address	103.80.134.63
Malware Process	Coffee.exe
SHA256 Hash	CD903AD2211CF7D166646D75E57FB866000F4A3B870B5EC759929BE2FD81D334
C2 IP Address	37.120.233.226
C2 Port	3451

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique Name	Evidence
Initial Access	T1566.001	Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment	Malicious ZIP attachment
Execution	T1204.002	User Execution: Malicious File	User executed Coffee.exe
Command and Control	T1071	Application Layer Protocol	Connection to C2 server

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique Name	Evidence
Command and Control	T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	Malware downloaded and executed
Persistence / Execution	T1059	Command and Scripting Interpreter	cmd.exe spawned child processes

Actions Taken

Phase	Action
Detection	Alert generated for deceptive phishing email
Analysis	Reviewed sender, attachment, and recipient details
Investigation	Confirmed user downloaded malicious file
Validation	Verified malware execution on endpoint
Network Analysis	Identified outbound communication to C2 infrastructure
Classification	Marked alert as True Positive
Documentation	Recorded findings and indicators

Root Cause Analysis

The incident originated from a phishing email disguised as a promotional coffee voucher. The message contained a malicious ZIP attachment that successfully bypassed initial user suspicion. The recipient downloaded and executed the payload, resulting in malware execution and communication with an external Command-and-Control server.

The primary root cause was successful phishing-based social engineering combined with user execution of an untrusted attachment.

Recommendations

Immediate Actions

- Block the sender domain and email address.
- Block C2 IP address 37.120.233.226.
- Quarantine and remove Coffee.exe from affected systems.
- Scan endpoints for additional malware activity.

Security Improvements

- Enable advanced email filtering and attachment sandboxing.
- Block executable content delivered through compressed archives.
- Implement endpoint detection and response (EDR) monitoring.
- Restrict execution from user download directories.

User Awareness

- Conduct phishing awareness training.
- Educate users about suspicious promotional offers.
- Encourage immediate reporting of unexpected attachments.

Monitoring Enhancements

- Create SIEM alerts for suspicious ZIP attachments.
 - Monitor outbound traffic to known malicious IPs.
 - Alert on unknown executable launches from Downloads folders.
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Final Verdict

Classification: True Positive

Incident Summary: A phishing email containing a malicious ZIP attachment successfully led to malware execution on the victim endpoint. The malware established communication with a Command-and-Control server, confirming malicious activity. The incident was investigated, documented, and resolved.



How to Investigate a SIEM Alert?

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